

> AN INSTRUMENT FOR THE EXAMINED LIFE



# SOCRATES AI ■

AI that sharpens your thinking instead of replacing it.

YANCUN ZHU · THEME A.3 · HUMAN AGENCY IN AI-MEDIATED DECISIONS

FIG.01

Sharp students defended theses  
they never thought through.

FIG.02 · THEME A.3

Agency isn't an override button.  
It's whether you still think.

FIG.03

Not an oracle. A midwife  
for your thinking.

ASKS BEFORE IT ANSWERS · PRESSES · NEVER FLATTERS · KEEPS THE RECORD



FRIDAY, JUNE 26

# > Afternoon, Human.

FIG.01 · TODAY, DISTILLED

Today the month-long thread finally said its own name. Watching a classmate defend an essay he could argue for but not reason through, you stopped circling and named it: AI agency was never about whether the machine can act for you. It's whether you still think — or whether you've handed it over and kept the feeling of having thought.

You turned the line on your own product, which is the only honest place to point it: every feature is a fork — does it make someone stronger without you, or weaker without you? You decided it never hands you the conclusion, even when handing it over would feel kinder.

WORTH RETURNING TO

When does a tool stop sharpening your thinking and start replacing it — and how

> THE FIELD OF YOUR THINKING

# The bank

 FIELD  LIST

THE FIELD



Each dot is a thought; the ones you keep returning to plot brighter and larger. Select one to read it.

- ▲ AI AGENCY WAS NEVER ABOUT WHETHER THE MACHINE CAN ...
- ♦ THE MODEL HANDS YOU THE MOST CONFIDENT VERSION OF W...
- WATCHED A CLASSMATE DEFEND AN ESSAY HE DIDN'T WRITE...
- ▲ EVERY FEATURE IS A FORK: DOES THIS MAKE SOMEONE ST...



&gt; CHAT

Think it through in writing.

division first, then handed it off. What if the order reverses, and someone outsources the reasoning BEFORE they ever built it? Is that the same trade, or a different one?

YOU

Different. You can't outsource a muscle you never grew. Augmentation needs a base to augment.

⚙️ SOCRATES

Then you've found your own dividing line, and it's sharper than "AI good / AI bad."  
Which side of your own line does Socrates have to stay on?

&gt; What's on your mind?



FIG.07 · LIVE — THE REAL THING



Let me show you.

Call my phone

...or talk to it in the browser



FIG.08 · WHO IT'S FOR

PERSONAL

People who want AI to sharpen them, not hollow them out: a place to think ideas through and keep their own cognition.

EDUCATION

Institutions — schools, boards, parents — that want AI-literacy which protects and develops student thinking.

The values are the moat.

● ● ● SOCRATES · /CALLS

📞 PHONE CALL

16M

Tue, Jun 24 · 9:14 PM

> WHAT SURFACED

DECISION

It never hands you the conclusion. It makes you take the last step yourself, even when handing it over would feel kinder.

QUESTION

Does Socrates make people still think — or does it just hand them a better-feeling conclusion?

✓ TRANSCRIPT

# A generation that thinks harder because of its tools — not softer.

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The Socratic dialogue, distillation, and the embeddings that form the memory.



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The real-time voice agent — Socrates you can talk to, on the phone or in the browser.

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Vercel

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